

Jackson Brooks

JULY 2026

Locati Architects
Bozeman, Montana

Dear Locati Architects,

My grandfather built a life on the water, and for much of my childhood that life was centered around a river house in Silverthorne, Colorado, a house your firm designed nearly a decade ago. Every year I returned to that house, I found myself studying it more than inhabiting it. The woodwork in the ceilings, the way the stone exterior seemed to settle into the base of the mountain, the window placement that framed the river as deliberately as any painting; these were not details I could name at the time, but they were shaping the way I understood what architecture could do. That house remains one of the most formative places in my life, and it is the reason I am writing to you now.

I am a third-year architecture student at California Baptist University pursuing a B.Arch/M.Arch, and I am seeking a summer internship with Locati Architects for 2027. My academic work has consistently oriented itself around regional and traditional building. The projects I have chosen in studio, and the subjects I return to in my observational drawing, reflect a sustained interest in architecture that belongs to its place. I believe a building should carry the memory of its landscape, its materials, and the people who made it.

This summer I made a deliberate choice to work at Homestead Timber Frames in Cookeville, Tennessee, a traditional mortise and tenon construction company that builds mountain homes. My work there is entirely hands-on: I spend my days in the shop chiseling, sawing, and sanding large timbers that our team then assembles on site. I sought this experience specifically because I believe that understanding how a building is actually made, how wood behaves under a chisel, how a joint transfers load, how a frame goes up, is foundational to designing with that vocabulary honestly. I wanted to be useful to a firm like yours, and I thought the best way to become useful was to begin with the material itself.

I would be grateful for the opportunity to contribute to your studio in summer 2027. My work and background can be found at jacksonbrooksdesign.com, and I am glad to provide any additional materials upon request. Thank you for the work you have put into the world, including one house on a river in Silverthorne that I will never stop thinking about.

Sincerely,

Jackson Brooks

B.ARCH / M.ARCH CANDIDATE · CALIFORNIA BAPTIST UNIVERSITY · CLASS OF 2029